

2 Subject content

Qualification aims and objectives

The aims and objectives of this qualification are to enable students to:

- develop and extend their knowledge and understanding of specified key events, periods and societies in local, British, and wider world history; and of the wide diversity of human experience
- engage in historical enquiry to develop as independent learners and as critical and reflective thinkers
- develop the ability to ask relevant questions about the past, to investigate issues critically and to make valid historical claims by using a range of sources in their historical context
- develop an awareness of why people, events and developments have been accorded historical significance and how and why different interpretations have been constructed about them
- organise and communicate their historical knowledge and understanding in different ways and reach substantiated conclusions.

Summary of Department for Education content requirements

This GCSE complies with the requirements specified by the Department for Education (DfE) in its document *History GCSE subject content* (published April 2014). This requires students to study, as a minimum:

- two **depth studies**, each covering a substantial and short time span:
 - one must be a British depth study from the medieval (500–1500), early modern (1450–1700) or modern (1750–present) eras
 - the other must be a **European or wider-world depth study** from an era different to the British depth study
- a **period study** of at least 50 years from any of the eras
- the **historic environment** through the study of a particular site in its historical context
- a **thematic study** involving the study of people, events and developments drawn from all three eras defined above.

The DfE also requires that British history must form at least 40% of the assessed content.

Creating a coherent and substantial course of study

The DfE's *History GCSE subject content* (April 2014) requires that GCSE History qualifications 'must provide a coherent and substantial course of study'.

Pearson has provided options in this specification that, in combination, will enable centres to create courses that are coherent and substantial. It is important that centres are clear about how their chosen combinations of options meet this requirement. Further information about different approaches to this can be found in *Appendix 2*.

How content is expressed

Centres should refer to Appendix 3, which provides guidance about how to interpret the requirements and expectations around what is taught in the topics.

Entry codes

The tables in *Appendix 1* show the entry codes that must be used for a centre's chosen options.